

SHREEYASH COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

Department of Computer Science & Engineering / Information Technology

SYCET IGNITE HACKATHON 2026

Official Rules, Regulations & Judging Criteria Document

EVENT NAME	SYCET IGNITE Hackathon 2026
ORGANIZED BY	Shreeyash College of Engineering and Technology
MODE	Hybrid
DURATION	1 Week (7 Days)
HACKATHON PERIOD	7 May 2026 to 13 May 2026
SUBMISSION DEADLINE	14 May 2026, Before 11:00 PM
SUBMISSION MODE	GitHub Repository Link (Mandatory)
TEAM SIZE	Minimum 1 — Maximum 4 Members
TARGET PARTICIPANTS	All Current Bonafide Students of the Institution
ACADEMIC YEAR	2025–2026

1. GENERAL RULES & REGULATIONS

1. All participants must be currently enrolled students of Shreeyash College of Engineering and Technology (SYCET) with a valid college ID.
2. Each team must consist of a minimum of **1 member** and a maximum of **4 members**. Solo participation is permitted.
3. A student **cannot be part of more than one team**. If found, both teams will be disqualified.
4. Teams must **register online** through the official registration portal before the registration deadline.
5. Late registrations will **not be entertained** under any circumstances.
6. All team members must belong to **Shreeyash College of Engineering and Technology**. Cross-college teams are not permitted.
7. The hackathon is a **1-week development period (7 May to 13 May 2026)** — it is NOT a 24-hour continuous event.
8. Teams may work on their projects at their own pace during the 1-week window, balancing with regular academics.
9. The decision of the judges and organizing committee shall be **final and binding**. No appeals or disputes will be entertained.
10. The organizing committee reserves the right to **modify rules** at any point. Changes will be communicated via official channels.
11. Any form of **plagiarism, code theft, or using pre-built projects** will lead to immediate disqualification.
12. Teams must maintain **professional conduct** throughout the event — in discussions, submissions, and interactions with mentors/judges.

13. Use of **profane language, inappropriate content, or offensive themes** in the project or presentation is strictly prohibited.
14. All participants must attend the **final presentation/demo round** (offline or online as per hybrid mode) to be eligible for prizes.

2. EVENT TIMELINE & SCHEDULE

1 May 2026	→ Registration portal opens
5 May 2026	→ Registration deadline (no extensions)
7 May 2026	→ Hackathon coding period officially begins
10 May 2026	→ Optional: Mid-review / mentor interaction session (if applicable)
13 May 2026	→ Hackathon coding period ends
14 May 2026	→ Submission deadline — Before 11:00 PM (GitHub link + documentation)
15 May 2026	→ Shortlisted teams announced
16 May 2026	→ Final presentation & demo round (Hybrid mode)
16 May 2026	→ Results declaration & prize distribution

3. SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

1. All submissions must be made via the **official submission form** before **11:00 PM on 14 May 2026**.
2. A **valid GitHub repository link** is **mandatory**. Submissions without a GitHub link will be automatically rejected.
3. The GitHub repository must be **public** (or shared with the organizing committee's GitHub account if private).
4. The repository must contain a proper **README.md** file with: Project title, description, tech stack, installation instructions, team details, and screenshots/demo links.
5. All team members' GitHub profiles must show **commit history** during the hackathon period (7–13 May 2026) to verify original work.
6. Teams must also submit a **project documentation** (PDF, max 5 pages) covering: problem statement, solution approach, architecture, features, challenges faced, and future scope.
7. A **demo video** (2–5 minutes) is highly recommended showing the working project, features, and user flow.
8. **No changes** to the GitHub repository will be allowed after the submission deadline. Any commits pushed after 11:00 PM on 14 May 2026 will not be considered.
9. Teams are advised to submit early to avoid last-minute technical issues. The committee is **not responsible** for network/server failures at the last moment.

⚠ Important: The GitHub repository must clearly show development activity during the 1-week hackathon period (7–13 May 2026). Repositories with all commits on a single day (especially the last day) may be flagged for review and could lead to deduction of points or disqualification if plagiarism is suspected.

4. PROJECT DEVELOPMENT RULES

1. The project must be built **from scratch** during the hackathon period (7–13 May 2026).
2. Teams may use **open-source libraries, frameworks, and APIs**, but core logic and implementation must be original.
3. Use of **pre-built templates, themes, or boilerplate code** (beyond standard scaffolding like create-react-app, django-admin startproject, etc.) must be disclosed in the README.
4. **AI tools** (ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, etc.) may be used for **reference and assistance only**. Blindly copying AI-generated code without understanding is prohibited and will be checked during the demo round.
5. The project must be **relevant to the given theme/problem statements**. Off-topic submissions will not be evaluated.
6. Teams can choose any **programming language, framework, or technology stack** of their choice — web, mobile, desktop, IoT, ML/AI, blockchain, etc.
7. The project should be in a **working/demo-able state**. Partially completed projects with no functional output will receive significantly reduced points.
8. Teams must ensure their project does not **violate any third-party licenses, copyrights, or intellectual property rights**.
9. Projects involving **database usage** must include proper schema design and sample data for demo purposes.
10. Projects must not contain any **malicious code, backdoors, or harmful content**.

5. DOS AND DON'TS FOR TEAMS

✓ DO'S	X DON'TS
Start planning your project as soon as problem statements are released Divide responsibilities among team members (frontend, backend, documentation, etc.) Maintain consistent commit history on GitHub throughout the week Write clean, well-commented, and properly indented code Create a comprehensive README.md with all required details Use Git branches for parallel development (main, dev, feature branches) Test your project thoroughly before the final submission Prepare a demo script for the final presentation round on 16 May 2026 Document challenges faced and how you overcame them Use version control properly with meaningful commit messages Disclose all third-party libraries, APIs, and resources used Keep backup of your code on multiple platforms if needed Follow responsive design principles for web projects Include error handling and input validation in your application Respect the hackathon timeline and submit before 11:00 PM on 14 May 2026	Do NOT copy code from GitHub, Stack Overflow, or any source without understanding and attribution Do NOT submit a project built before 7 May 2026 Do NOT be part of multiple teams — you can only join one team Do NOT submit someone else's project or repository as your own Do NOT push all commits on the final day to fake development activity Do NOT use paid APIs/services without proper licensing or disclosure Do NOT ignore the README file — an incomplete README costs points Do NOT submit empty repositories or repositories with only README Do NOT make any commits to the repository after 11:00 PM on 14 May 2026 Do NOT use offensive, discriminatory, or inappropriate content in the project Do NOT share your project/solution with other teams during the hackathon Do NOT misrepresent your tech stack or features in the documentation Do NOT argue with judges or organizers regarding evaluation decisions Do NOT ignore the presentation round on 16 May 2026 — absence means no evaluation Do NOT submit links to cloud deployments without providing source code

6. JUDGING CRITERIA — POINTS DISTRIBUTION & WEIGHTAGE

Total Evaluation Points: **100 Points** | Evaluation is based on two components: **Pre-submission Review (GitHub + Documentation)** and **Live Presentation/Demo Round on 16 May 2026**.

#	CRITERIA	POINTS	WEIGHT	SUB-CRITERIA / EVALUATION PARAMETERS	ROUND
1	Innovation & Originality	20	20%	- Uniqueness of the idea/solution (0–5) - Creative approach to solving the problem (0–5) - Originality — not a clone of existing apps (0–5) - Novel use of technology (0–5)	Both
2	Functionality & Completeness	20	20%	- Core features are fully functional (0–6) - End-to-end workflow works without errors (0–5) - Error handling and edge cases covered (0–4) - Completeness relative to proposed scope (0–5)	Demo
3	Code Quality & GitHub Hygiene	15	15%	- Clean, readable, well-structured code (0–4) - Proper comments and documentation in code (0–3) - Consistent commit history throughout the week (0–4) - Meaningful commit messages and branch usage (0–2) - Proper .gitignore and repo structure (0–2)	Pre-Review
4	UI/UX & Design	10	10%	- Visual appeal and consistent design language (0–3) - User-friendly navigation and flow (0–3) - Responsive design (for web projects) (0–2) - Accessibility considerations (0–2)	Demo
5	Technical Complexity	10	10%	- Complexity of algorithms/logic implemented (0–3) - Appropriate use of data structures (0–2) - Integration of multiple technologies/APIs (0–3) - Database design and data management (0–2)	Both
6	Documentation & README	10	10%	- Complete README with all required sections (0–4) - Clear installation and setup instructions (0–2) - Screenshots/demo links included (0–2) - Project documentation PDF quality (0–2)	Pre-Review

#	CRITERIA	POINTS	WEIGHT	SUB-CRITERIA / EVALUATION PARAMETERS	ROUND
7	Relevance to Theme / Problem Statement	10	10%	- Direct alignment with the chosen theme (0–4) - Practical real-world applicability (0–3) - Potential social/environmental/industry impact (0–3)	Both
8	Presentation & Demo Quality	5	5%	- Clarity of explanation and communication (0–2) - Smooth demo flow without glitches (0–2) - Ability to answer judges' questions (0–1)	Demo
TOTAL		100	100%		

POINTS SUMMARY — QUICK REFERENCE

Innovation & Originality	20 pts	Technical Complexity	10 pts
Functionality & Completeness	20 pts	Documentation & README	10 pts
Code Quality & GitHub Hygiene	15 pts	Relevance to Theme	10 pts
UI/UX & Design	10 pts	Presentation & Demo	5 pts

7. GROUNDS FOR DISQUALIFICATION

1. **Plagiarism:** Submitting copied code, projects, or ideas from any source without original contribution.
2. **Pre-built Projects:** Submitting a project that was significantly developed before 7 May 2026.
3. **Multiple Teams:** A student found registered in more than one team.
4. **Missing Submission:** Failure to submit the GitHub link before 11:00 PM on 14 May 2026.
5. **Empty/Invalid Repository:** Submitting a GitHub link that is empty, inaccessible, or does not contain project code.
6. **Fake Commit History:** Manipulating Git timestamps or pushing all code at once to simulate development activity.
7. **Misconduct:** Unprofessional behavior towards organizers, mentors, judges, or fellow participants.
8. **Absence in Demo Round:** Not showing up for the final presentation on 16 May 2026 without prior intimation.
9. **Inappropriate Content:** Projects containing offensive, discriminatory, harmful, or illegal content.
10. **Violation of IP Rights:** Using proprietary code, assets, or content without proper licensing.

8. IMPORTANT NOTES & CLARIFICATIONS

- ◆ The 1-week duration (7–13 May 2026) is provided to allow students to balance academic commitments. This does **not** mean students should neglect the project until the last day.
- ◆ Teams are encouraged to interact with mentors (if provided) during the hackathon period for guidance.
- ◆ In case of a **tie in total points**, the team with higher points in "Innovation & Originality" will be ranked higher. If still tied, "Functionality & Completeness" will be considered, and so on.
- ◆ The organizing committee may arrange **optional mid-review sessions** to track progress. Attendance (if conducted) may carry bonus points.
- ◆ All communication will be done through **official channels only** (email, official WhatsApp group, college notice board). Information from unofficial sources will not be entertained.
- ◆ Certificates will be issued to **all participants who submit a valid project**. Certificates of merit will be issued to winners and runners-up.
- ◆ Prizes will be distributed on **16 May 2026** immediately after the results declaration at SYCET. Absence may lead to forfeiture.
- ◆ As this is a **hybrid mode** event, the final demo round on 16 May 2026 may be conducted offline at SYCET campus or online via video call. The mode for each shortlisted team will be communicated separately on 15 May 2026.

⚠ DISCLAIMER

The organizing committee of SYCET IGNITE Hackathon 2026 reserves the right to amend any rules mentioned in this document. Any changes will be communicated to all registered teams via official channels. Participation in the hackathon implies acceptance of all rules, regulations, and the decision of the judges as final.

9. CONTACT INFORMATION

EVENT COORDINATORS (STUDENT)

COORDINATOR 1	
COORDINATOR 2	

COORDINATOR 3	
----------------------	--

FACULTY COORDINATORS

FACULTY 1	
FACULTY 2	

DEAN

DEAN	
PRINCIPAL	

JUDGING PANEL

JUDGE 1	
JUDGE 2	
JUDGE 3	
JUDGE 4	

10. AUTHORIZED SIGNATURES

JUDGING PANEL

JUDGE 1

JUDGE 2

JUDGE 3

JUDGE 4

DEAN

DEAN

SEAL

PRINCIPAL

PRINCIPAL

Shreyash College of Engineering and
Technology

FACULTY COORDINATORS

FACULTY COORDINATOR 1

FACULTY COORDINATOR 2

EVENT COORDINATORS (STUDENT)

EVENT COORDINATOR 1

EVENT COORDINATOR 2

EVENT COORDINATOR 3